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SoftBank eyes up to \$40 billion loan to fund OpenAI investment, Bloomberg News reports

By Reuters

March 6, 2026 12:27 PM GMT+8 · Updated March 6, 2026



A view of the OpenAI and SoftBank Group logos on the day of an event to pitch AI for businesses in Tokyo, Japan February 3, 2025. REUTERS/Kim Kyung-Hoon [Purchase Licensing Rights](#)

March 6 (Reuters) - Japanese conglomerate SoftBank ([9984.T](#)) is seeking a loan of up to \$40 billion, primarily to finance its investment in ChatGPT-maker OpenAI, Bloomberg News reported on Friday, citing people familiar with the matter.

The bridge loan would hold a roughly 12-month tenor, Bloomberg reported, with four lenders, including JPMorgan ([JPM.N](#)) , underwriting the facility.

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Ta 10 nks are ongoing, and terms could change, according to the report.

Reuters could not immediately verify the report. OpenAI and SoftBank did not immediately respond to Reuters' request for a comment.

SoftBank Chief Executive Masayoshi Son has made an "all in" bet on OpenAI, ramping up investment in artificial intelligence. The Japanese firm held a stake of about 11% in OpenAI at the end of last year.

OpenAI is laying the groundwork for an IPO that could value the company at up to \$1 trillion, Reuters exclusively reported last year.

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Last month, the firm said it would raise \$110 billion in a funding round that could value it at \$840 billion, including \$30 billion each from SoftBank and U.S. chipmaker Nvidia (NVDA.O) [↗](#), and \$50 billion from e-commerce retailer Amazon (AMZN.O) [↗](#).

Reporting by Gursimran Kaur in Bengaluru; Editing by Sherry Jacob-Phillips

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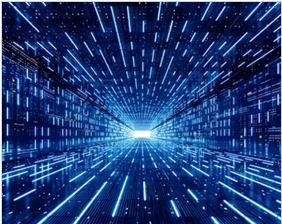
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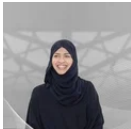
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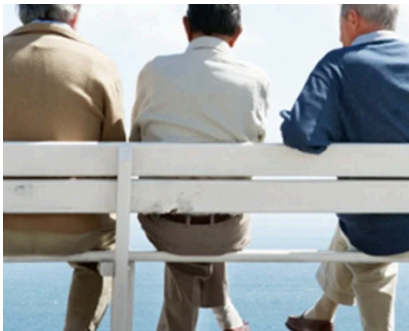
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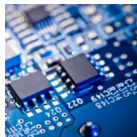
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